

ACADEMIC CURRICULUM FRAMEWORK

The History Portal History Department

WHOLE SCHOOL CURRICULUM OVERVIEW

Comprehensive Sequential Mapping • Key Stages 3 & 4 (Years 7 – 11) • 2026–2027

HEAD OF HISTORY

Department Lead

EXAM SPECIFICATION

Pearson Edexcel GCSE (9-1)

ACADEMIC YEAR

2026 – 2027

QUALITY ASSURANCE

Educational Trust Curriculum Standard

TERM	Autumn 1	Autumn 2	Spring 1	Spring 2	Summer 1	Summer 2
TOPIC & ENQUIRY	Water & Sanitation Through Time		Medieval England (1066–1485)			
SUMMARY OF OBJECTIVES	Pupils trace the history of public health from Roman aqueducts through medieval cesspits to Victorian sewers, evaluating why progress was not linear and how government attitudes shaped change over time.		Pupils explore the power struggles that defined England from the Norman Conquest to the Wars of the Roses, examining how monarchs, the Church, and ordinary people competed for authority and power across the High and Late Middle Ages.			
KNOWLEDGE & SKILLS	KEY VOCAB Aqueduct, Cesspit, Miasma Theory, Cholera, Laissez-faire, Germ Theory, Public Health Act 1848 SKILLS Change & Continuity, Causation, Source Comprehension, PEEL Paragraphs		KEY VOCAB Feudalism, Domesday Book, Magna Carta, Crusade, Black Death, Peasants' Revolt SKILLS Causation, Significance, Source Utility, Historical Argumentation (PEEL)			
ASSESSMENT	ASSESSMENT Extended PEEL paragraphs at the end of each period studied. Unit assessment: "Why did it take so long to clean up Britain?" (extended writing)		ASSESSMENT Formative PEEL paragraphs throughout. Mid-unit assessment: Magna Carta baronial enquiry. Final assessment: 12-mark extended essay — "Explain why the peasants revolted in 1381."			
SMSC	Social: Responsibility for community health. Moral: Should governments compel people to change behaviour for the public good? Cultural: How different civilisations approached hygiene.		Spiritual: Power and influence of the medieval Church. Social: Feudal hierarchy and peasant resistance. Moral: Is rebellion ever justified?			
CAREERS	Public Health Officer, Epidemiologist, Archaeologist, Environmental Scientist		Archivist, Heritage Site Manager, Historian, Lawyer			

TERM	Autumn 1	Autumn 2	Spring 1	Spring 2	Summer 1	Summer 2
TOPIC & ENQUIRY	Early Modern World (1450–1750)		Industrialisation & Empire (1750–1900)		History of Australia	
SUMMARY OF OBJECTIVES	Pupils examine why Europe was not the centre of global power in 1450, how religious conflict triggered exploration, and how early trading encounters escalated into empire and the Transatlantic Slave Trade.		Pupils investigate how industrialisation transformed Britain into the world's first industrial superpower and evaluate the human cost of factory life, urbanisation, and imperial expansion across the globe.		Pupils critically examine the British colonisation of Australia, from the decision to establish a penal colony to the devastating and lasting impact on Indigenous peoples and their enduring resistance.	
KNOWLEDGE & SKILLS	KEY VOCAB Reformation, Conquistador, Transatlantic Slave Trade, East India Company, Colonisation, Triangular Trade SKILLS Significance, Historical Interpretations, Comparative Analysis, Extended Writing (PEEL)		KEY VOCAB Industrial Revolution, Urbanisation, Child Labour, Imperialism, Chartism, Free Trade, Working Class SKILLS Change & Continuity, Source Analysis, Comparative Judgement, Extended Writing		KEY VOCAB Terra Nullius, Convict, Indigenous, Dreaming, Dispossession, Penal Colony, First Fleet SKILLS Empathy & Perspective, Source Evaluation, Historical Significance, Causation	
ASSESSMENT	ASSESSMENT Formative PEEL paragraphs and source work throughout. Final assessment: "To what extent was greed the main cause of European exploration?"		ASSESSMENT Formative source analysis and knowledge checks. Final assessment: "Was the British Empire a force for good or harm?" (extended judgement essay)		ASSESSMENT Analytical written response: "How significant was the impact of British colonisation on Indigenous Australians?"	
SMSC	Moral: Ethics of colonisation, slavery, and cultural destruction. Social: Impact of global trade on indigenous societies. Cultural: Encountering and evaluating diverse civilisations.		Social: Urbanisation, child labour, and inequality. Moral: Was Empire a force for good or exploitation? Cultural: Impact of industrialisation on working-class life and identity.		Cultural: Respect for Indigenous Australian heritage and traditions. Moral: Legacies of penal transportation and dispossession. Social: Long-term impact of colonialism on First Nations peoples.	
CAREERS	Museum Curator, International Relations Analyst, Human Rights Lawyer		Urban Planner, Economist, Politician, Museum Educator		Anthropologist, Human Rights Advocate, Social Worker, Journalist	

Year 9 History Curriculum Overview 2026–2027

KEY STAGE 3

TERM	Autumn 1	Autumn 2	Spring 1	Spring 2	Summer 1	Summer 2
TOPIC & ENQUIRY	Causes of the Great War (1870–1914)	The Great War (1914–1919)	The Shoah & World War II		The Cold War	Rights, Protest & Post-War Britain
SUMMARY OF OBJECTIVES	Pupils analyse the complex web of long and short-term causes of the First World War, including militarism, imperialism, the alliance system, nationalism, and the assassination of Franz Ferdinand.	Pupils investigate the lived experience of the trenches, challenge the "Lions led by Donkeys" debate, uncover the forgotten contributions of Empire troops, and evaluate the consequences of the Treaty of Versailles.	Pupils study the deep roots of antisemitism, the escalating persecution under Nazi rule, and the systematic genocide of the Holocaust contextualised by the Second World War and Operation Barbarossa, developing an understanding of moral responsibility and remembrance.		Pupils explore how the wartime alliance between the USA and USSR collapsed into ideological rivalry, examining key flashpoints from the Berlin Blockade to the Cuban Missile Crisis and the fall of the Berlin Wall.	Pupils evaluate the transformation of Britain from 1945 to 2000 — from the creation of the Welfare State and the NHS to the Windrush generation and the ongoing struggle for equality and civil rights.
KNOWLEDGE & SKILLS	KEY VOCAB Militarism, Alliance System, Imperialism, Nationalism, Assassination, Schlieffen Plan, Arms Race SKILLS Causation (Long & Short-term), Source Utility, Historical Interpretations, PEEL Paragraphs	KEY VOCAB Trench Warfare, Attrition, Shell Shock, Somme, Treaty of Versailles, Conscripted, Empire Troops SKILLS Historical Interpretations, Source Utility, Evaluative Judgement, Essay Writing	KEY VOCAB Antisemitism, Pogrom, Nuremberg Laws, Kristallnacht, Ghetto, Einsatzgruppen, Final Solution SKILLS Source Evaluation, Causation, Historical Significance, Extended Writing		KEY VOCAB Capitalism, Communism, Iron Curtain, Proxy War, Nuclear Deterrence, Berlin Wall, Détente SKILLS Causation, Consequence, Source Utility, Comparative Analysis	KEY VOCAB Welfare State, NHS, Windrush, Civil Rights, Feminist Movement, Deindustrialisation, Multicultural SKILLS Change & Continuity, Significance, Source Analysis, Extended Writing
ASSESSMENT	ASSESSMENT Formative source utility tasks throughout. Final assessment: "Was the assassination of Franz Ferdinand the main cause of the First World War?" (16-mark essay)	ASSESSMENT Final assessment: "How far do you agree that the Treaty of Versailles made a second world war inevitable?" (16-mark interpretations essay)	ASSESSMENT Analytical essay: "How did ordinary people become perpetrators of genocide?" Pupil Voice reflection exercise on Holocaust Memorial Day.		ASSESSMENT Formative knowledge checks and source tasks. Final assessment: "Who was more to blame for the Cold War — the USA or the USSR?" (extended judgement essay)	ASSESSMENT Final assessment: "How much did Britain change between 1945 and 2000?" — a thematic extended writing response.
SMSC	Moral: Duty, sacrifice, and the ethics of warfare. Social: Impact of war on local communities — Stubbington's "Lost Generation". Cultural: War poetry, propaganda, and remembrance.	Moral: The "Lions led by Donkeys" debate. Social: Forgotten contributions of Empire soldiers. Cultural: Remembrance and collective memory.	Moral: Profound reflection on genocide, prejudice, and human rights. Social: Bystander responsibility and moral courage. Spiritual: The Holocaust's impact on faith and human meaning.		Moral: Ethics of nuclear deterrence and proxy wars. Social: Ideological division of the world. Cultural: The propaganda war, the space race, and cultural competition.	Social: Creation of the Welfare State, Windrush, and multiculturalism. Moral: Equality, protest, and civil rights in post-war Britain. Cultural: Immigration and the evolution of British identity.
CAREERS	Military Historian, Diplomat, Archivist, Journalist	Military Historian, Diplomat, Archivist, Documentary Maker	Human Rights Advocate, Educator, Ethics Adviser, Museum Curator		Political Scientist, Intelligence Analyst, Diplomat, Journalist	Sociologist, Public Policy Analyst, Civil Servant, Teacher

TERM	Autumn 1	Autumn 2	Spring 1	Spring 2	Summer 1	Summer 2
TOPIC & ENQUIRY	Paper 2: Conflict in the Middle East (1945–1995)			Paper 3: Weimar & Nazi Germany (1918–39)		
SUMMARY OF OBJECTIVES	Pupils study the origins and escalation of the Arab-Israeli conflict from the end of the British Mandate to the Oslo Accords, analysing the wars of 1948, 1956, 1967, and 1973 and the search for peace.			Pupils analyse the rise and fall of the Weimar Republic, Hitler's consolidation of power, and the structures of the Nazi totalitarian state, developing skills to evaluate sources and historical interpretations.		
KNOWLEDGE & SKILLS	KEY VOCAB Zionism, Mandate, Balfour Declaration, Intifada, PLO, Occupied Territories, Oslo Accords SKILLS Consequence (4 marks), Narrative Account (8 marks), Importance (8 marks), GCSE Exam Technique			KEY VOCAB Hyperinflation, Reichstag, Enabling Act, Gestapo, Propaganda, Kristallnacht, Autarky SKILLS Source Inference (4 marks), Source Utility (8 marks), Interpretations (4+16+4 marks), GCSE Exam Technique		
ASSESSMENT	ASSESSMENT Edexcel Paper 2 (Period Study) exam practice throughout: 4-mark consequence questions, 8-mark narrative accounts, and 8-mark importance questions. End of unit mock under timed conditions.			ASSESSMENT Edexcel Paper 3 exam practice: 4-mark inference, 8-mark utility, and 16-mark (+4 SPaG) interpretations essays. End of unit timed mock assessment.		
SMSC	Moral: Ethics of partition, displacement, and military conflict. Social: Impact of prolonged war on civilian populations and refugees. Cultural: Religious and national identity in the Middle East.			Moral: How democracy can be destroyed from within. Social: Impact of propaganda and totalitarianism on everyday society. Cultural: Weimar cultural revolution versus Nazi cultural control.		
CAREERS	Diplomat, Foreign Correspondent, International Aid Worker, Political Analyst			Political Analyst, Human Rights Lawyer, Journalist, Educator		

TERM	Autumn 1	Autumn 2	Spring 1	Spring 2	Summer 1	Summer 2
TOPIC & ENQUIRY	Paper 1: Medicine Through Time			Paper 2: Early Elizabethan England (1558–88)		GCSE Revision & Examinations
SUMMARY OF OBJECTIVES	Pupils study how ideas about the cause, prevention, and treatment of disease changed from the medieval period to the present day, and how the extreme conditions of the Western Front drove surgical innovation. Supported by the biannual GCSE Ypres Battlefield Tour (Years 10–11) investigating historic British sector dressing stations, casualty evacuation chains, and the Menin Gate.			Pupils examine the political, religious, and social challenges Elizabeth I faced — from the religious settlement and Catholic plots to the threat of the Spanish Armada — and evaluate her success as a monarch.		Targeted revision across all three papers using past papers, walking-talking mocks, and bespoke exam technique workshops.
KNOWLEDGE & SKILLS	KEY VOCAB Four Humours, Miasma, Vaccination, Germ Theory, Penicillin, Blood Transfusion, RAMC SKILLS Features (2+2 marks), Source Utility (8 marks), Similarity/Difference (4 marks), Explain Why (12 marks), Essay (16 marks + SPaG)			KEY VOCAB Religious Settlement, Puritan, Recusant, Mary Queen of Scots, Spanish Armada, Privateer, Poor Law SKILLS Features (2+2 marks), Explain Why (12 marks), Judgement Essay (16 marks), GCSE Exam Technique		SKILLS Timed exam practice, Source inference and utility, Extended writing, Self-assessment using mark schemes
ASSESSMENT	ASSESSMENT Edexcel Paper 1 exam practice throughout: Section A (Western Front features and source utility) and Section B (thematic similarity, causation, and judgement essays). End of unit timed mock: 16-mark essay.			ASSESSMENT Edexcel Paper 2 (British Depth Study) exam practice: Q1(a)&(b) 2-mark feature questions, Q2 12-mark causation, and Q3 16-mark judgement essay. End of unit timed mock.		ASSESSMENT Full timed mocks across Paper 1, 2, and 3. Walking-talking mock sessions and targeted one-to-one intervention.
SMSC	Social: Government responsibility for public health then and now. Moral: Ethics of medical experimentation, vaccination, and battlefield triage. Cultural: Collective memory, the Ypres Salient, and commemoration at the Menin Gate.			Spiritual: Religious conflict and the Elizabethan Religious Settlement. Cultural: Elizabethan theatre, maritime exploration, and court culture. Social: Poverty, vagrancy, and Elizabethan social control.		Resilience, self-regulation, growth mindset, and managing exam pressure.
CAREERS	Doctor, Medical Researcher, Public Health Policy Maker, Pharmacist			Heritage Consultant, Historian, Teacher, Lawyer		All career pathways — analytical thinking, written communication, and structured argument are transferable skills for any profession.